32. Self-defence — Krav Maga, boxing, Muay Thai and jiu-jitsu (principles and core techniques)

Oracle OS guide. **Illustrated** manuals in the library: US Army TC 3-25.150 and FM 3-25.150 "Combatives" (based on Brazilian jiu-jitsu, plus boxing and Muay Thai), USMC "Marine Corps Martial Arts Program" and belt manuals (tan, grey, green), and classic boxing books. Nothing replaces training with an instructor and a partner: techniques are learned by controlled repetition.

Law and priorities

- Self-defence is only lawful if it is **necessary and proportionate** to stop an ongoing attack (UK: "reasonable force"; Portugal: self-defence, art. 32 of the Penal Code; Brazil: art. 25, moderate use). When the danger ends, you stop. This is not legal advice.
- Order of priority: **notice early → avoid → calm it down → escape → fight only to get away**. Winning means getting home.

1. Awareness and avoidance

- Look around, no earphones in risky areas; note exits, groups, hidden hands, someone closing in fast.
- Cross the street, go into a shop, draw attention. Money and phones can be replaced; you can't.
- **De-escalate**: calm voice, short phrases ("I don't want trouble. I'm leaving."), no insults, open hands in front of the chest as a "fence" (looks peaceful but protects the face and keeps distance).

2. Stance and guard (the base of every art)

- Feet shoulder-width, one forward (the weak side), knees slightly bent, weight on the balls of the feet.
- Hands at cheekbone height, elbows by the ribs, chin down, eyes on the opponent's chest (you see hands and feet).
- Movement: short steps, the foot nearest the direction moves first; never cross the legs.

3. Boxing — hands

- **Jab** (lead hand): fast, straight, turn the fist at the end, back to guard at once. Measures distance.
- **Cross** (rear hand): rotate the hip and rear foot, straight arm, shoulder protects the chin.
- **Hook**: arm bent at 90°, rotate the trunk; close range.
- **Uppercut**: upward, bending the knees.
- **Defences**: block with gloves/forearms, **slip** (tilt the head aside), **roll** (bend the knees and go under), step back or pivot out.

- Training combos: 1-2 (jab-cross), 1-2-3 (+ hook), jab-cross-step out diagonally.

4. Muay Thai — "the art of eight limbs"

- **Teep (push kick)**: lift the knee and push with the sole into the belly/hip — great for keeping distance and making space to escape.
- **Low roundhouse** to the thigh: pivot the standing foot, strike with the shin, same-side arm swings down for balance.
- **Knees**: at close range, pull the head/shoulders and drive the knee up.
- **Elbows**: short and powerful; very dangerous — only if essential.
- **Clinch**: hands behind the opponent's head, elbows together, controls their posture.
- **Checking kicks**: lift the shin on the side being kicked.

5. Krav Maga — street principles

- **Defend and counter at the same time**; short burst, then **escape**.
- Targets that stop an attack (only to escape): eyes, nose, throat, groin, knees.
- **Wrist grab**: rotate your arm toward the grabber's **thumb** (the weakest point) and pull hard.
- **Front choke** (hands on the neck): tuck the chin, bring hooked hands up inside and rip the thumbs away ("plucking"), counter (knee) and leave.
- **Rear arm choke**: turn the chin into their elbow, pull the arm down with both hands, drop your centre of gravity, turn in and get out.
- **Bear hug**: drop your weight (bend knees), widen the base, strike backward (heel to the foot, elbows), break free and run.
- **Knife or weapon**: hand over what they ask for and **run**. Knife defence is extremely risky even for experts; use barriers (chair, backpack, coat wrapped round the arm) only if there is no other way out.

6. Jiu-jitsu and ground fighting (the basis of "Army Combatives")

- **Falling safely**: chin to chest, slap the ground with the arms when falling backward, roll over the shoulder (not the head).
- **Technical stand-up**: seated, one hand on the ground behind, same-side foot in front to fend off, lift the hips and sweep the leg back under, stand already in guard.
- **Closed guard**: on your back with legs locked round their waist, you control them and limit strikes; pull them close, control the arms.
- **Hip escape ("shrimp")**: on your side, push off with the feet and move the hips away to make space and bring the legs back in front.
- **Bridge and roll ("upa")** when someone is mounted on you: trap one of their arms and the same-side foot, bridge the hips hard and roll to that side.
- **Side control**: frame the neck with the forearm, hip-escape and recover guard.
- **Chokes and locks** (rear naked choke, guillotine, armbar): in training, release at the first tap. A choke can cause unconsciousness in seconds and death; on the street, only as a last resort and release as soon as the threat ends.

- Street goal: **don't stay on the ground** — control, get up and leave (there may be more attackers, glass, objects).

7. Protecting others

- Put the child/person behind you and back toward an exit. Shout clear instructions ("Run into the shop!").
- In a group, nobody chases the attacker — everyone leaves together.

8. Training plan (3× a week, 45–60 min)

1. Warm-up 10 min (skipping, mobility — see "Stretching and pain").
2. Technique 15 min: guard, footwork, jab-cross, teep, breakfalls, shrimp, bridge.
3. Bag or pads 3×3 min (combinations) with 1 min rest.
4. Partner work with control 10 min: wrist releases, slow-motion choke defences, technical stand-up.
5. Conditioning 5–10 min: push-ups, squats, core, sprints.
6. Stretching and breathing.
7. Protection: hand wraps, gloves, gum shield; stop if joints hurt; never train strikes to the neck or head at full power.

9. After an attack

Get somewhere safe, check for injuries (see "First aid"), call 999/112, write down the attacker's description and witnesses, seek emotional support ("Mental health in a crisis").